



# Module 02 — The Gnostic Worldview



**Module 2 of 8 — Gnostic Practices for Beginners.** Complete Module 1 first if you have not already. Enrol at [veilcartography.org](https://veilcartography.org)

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## Module 2 — The Gnostic Worldview



**What you will gain from this module:**

- Describe the Gnostic cosmology: Pleroma, Demiurge, Archons, and the divine spark
- Compare the Gnostic creation story with mainstream religious narratives
- Relate cosmological concepts to your own inner experience
- Complete a personal cosmology mapping exercise

**Duration:** 2.5 hours · 3 lessons + 1 workbook session

**Price:** £4.99 · Available at [veilcartography.org](https://veilcartography.org)

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### Lesson 2.1 — The Pleroma and the Fullness (30 min)

The Gnostic cosmos begins not with the physical universe but with a realm of pure divine light called the **Pleroma** — from the Greek meaning *fullness* or *completeness*. The Pleroma is not a place in the ordinary sense. It is the totality of divine being: infinite, self-sufficient, and radiantly alive.

Within the Pleroma exist divine emanations called **Aeons** — pairs of complementary principles that together constitute the fullness of divine reality.

Think of them as facets of the infinite, each expressing a particular quality of the divine nature: Depth and Silence, Mind and Truth, Word and Life, Human and Church.

### **The original wholeness:**

Before anything went wrong — before the material world came into being — there was only the Pleroma. Perfect, complete, luminous. The Gnostic tradition does not begin with a God who creates the world out of love or power. It begins with a God who simply *is*, in a state of absolute fullness, needing nothing outside itself.

This is a radical starting point. It means the material world is not the primary reality. It is a secondary, derived reality — and understanding *how* it came to be is the key to understanding why we feel, at some level, that we do not quite belong here.



**Reflection:** Have you ever had the sense that this world is not quite home? That you are somehow more than what the material world suggests? The Gnostics would say that feeling is the divine spark recognising its own origin.

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## **Lesson 2.2 — The Demiurge and the Material World (30 min)**

The Gnostic creation story diverges dramatically from the Genesis account at a single, crucial point: *who made the physical world, and why?*

In the Gnostic account, the physical universe was not created by the highest divine principle. It was created by a lesser being — a craftsman-god called the **Demiurge** (from the Greek *demiurgos*, meaning *craftsman* or *artisan*). The Demiurge is not evil in the simple sense. He is *ignorant*. He does not know that there is a higher divine reality above him. He believes himself to be the only God.

### **How the Demiurge came to be:**

The Apocryphon of John — one of the most important Nag Hammadi texts — tells the story of Sophia (Wisdom), one of the Aeons of the Pleroma. In an act of independent will, Sophia attempted to know the Father without her divine partner. From this act of reaching beyond her proper sphere, a flawed being was born: the Demiurge, also called Yaldabaoth.

Yaldabaoth, unaware of the Pleroma above him, declares: *"I am a jealous God, and there is no other God beside me."* The Gnostics read this as a direct reference to the God of the Old Testament — and as evidence that the God who made the material world is not the highest divine principle.

### **Matter is not evil — it is incomplete:**

This is an important nuance. The Gnostic tradition does not teach that the physical world is inherently evil or that the body is a prison to be escaped. Matter is simply *incomplete* — it is a world made by a being who did not have access to the full divine light. The divine spark within each human being is the evidence that the Pleroma's light reached even into this limited creation.



**Key distinction:** The Demiurge is not Satan. He is not malevolent — he is blind. The Gnostic path is not about escaping evil. It is about waking up to a larger reality that the Demiurge cannot see.

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## **Lesson 2.3 — The Divine Spark Within (30 min)**

Here is the central Gnostic teaching, the one that changes everything: **you carry a fragment of the Pleroma within you.**

The Gnostics called this the **pneuma** (spirit) or the **divine spark**. It is not metaphorical. It is the literal presence of the highest divine light, embedded in the human being at the moment of creation — placed there, according to the Apocryphon of John, when Sophia breathed her light into the first human against the Demiurge's intentions.

This means that every human being is, at their deepest level, a being of divine light temporarily housed in a material body in a world made by a limited craftsman. The Demiurge and his Archons (the planetary rulers who maintain the material order) do not want you to remember this. The Archons — which we will explore in depth in Module 6 — are the psychological and cosmic forces that keep the divine spark asleep.

### **What gnosis does:**

Gnosis — direct experiential knowledge of your own divine nature — is the act of *re-mem-ber-ing*. It is the moment the divine spark recognises itself. This is not an intellectual conclusion. It is a lived experience: a sudden clarity, a sense of recognition, a knowing that goes deeper than thought.

The Gnostic path is the systematic cultivation of the conditions in which this recognition can occur.



**Saying 3 from the Gospel of Thomas:** *"If those who lead you say to you: See, the Kingdom is in heaven, then the birds of heaven will precede you. If they say to you: It is in the sea, then the fish will precede you. But the Kingdom is within you and it is outside you. When you know yourselves, then you will be known, and you will know that you are the children of the living Father."*

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## Workbook 2 — Mapping Your Cosmology (30 min)

*Print this section or write your answers in a dedicated journal.*

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### Exercise 1 — Draw Your Cosmology

Before reading any further, take a blank page and draw your own cosmology — your intuitive sense of how reality is structured. Where is the divine? Where are you? What is between you and it? There is no right answer. This is your current map.

*Sketch here or in your journal:*

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### Exercise 2 — Genesis vs. Apocryphon of John

Read these two passages and note what is different:

**Genesis 1:1** — *"In the beginning God created the heavens and the earth."*

**Apocryphon of John** (paraphrase) — *"The perfect Pronoia of the All, the light, the life, the Mother-Father, the first human, the holy Spirit, the thrice-male, the thrice-powerful, the thrice-named androgynous one — and the eternal Aeon among the invisible ones — and the first to come forth..."*

What do you notice? What questions does the Apocryphon raise that Genesis does not?

*Your observations:*

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### Exercise 3 — Where Do You Feel the Spark?

Sit quietly for five minutes. Place your hand on your chest. Ask yourself: *Where in my body do I feel most alive? Most like myself?*

Write what you notice — sensations, images, words, feelings. This is not an intellectual exercise. Trust what comes.

*Your response:*

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### Module 2 Self-Check

Before moving to Module 3, confirm you can answer these without notes:

- ☐ I can explain what the Pleroma is in my own words
- ☐ I understand who the Demiurge is and why he is not the highest God
- ☐ I can describe what the divine spark is and where it comes from
- ☐ I have completed my personal cosmology drawing



**Next:** Module 3 — Sacred Texts Unlocked. You will navigate the Nag Hammadi Library and deep-dive into the Gospel of Thomas. Available at [veilcartography.org](http://veilcartography.org)

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